TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Tell What Happened During a Service Problem

Narrate | PPF | Story Interview

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Tell a friend or a customer service officer what happened with a delivery, a booking or a refund: set the scene, give the events in order and say how it ended.

WHO You live in Johor Bahru. Two weeks ago you ordered a microwave online for RM349. It was supposed to come on Saturday morning, so you waited at home.

SITUATION The rider came at 4 p.m., while you were having a shower, so you signed quickly. The box had a kettle in it! You waited 25 minutes on hold. The right microwave came three days later, on Tuesday.

NEED It is Thursday lunch. Mei Ling asks, 'So what happened with your microwave?' She was not there, so she needs the story in order. The shop promised you a RM30 voucher, but it has not come yet.

GOAL Tell the story so Mei Ling can follow it: set the scene → what happened, in order → how it ended → what you will do next time, and what is still open.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mei Ling asks: “Hey, you ordered a microwave online, right? Did it come in the end? What happened?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Siti's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Two weeks ago I ordered a microwave online, RM349, for Saturday morning. I was having a shower at home when the rider finally came at 4 p.m. And in the box? A kettle! Then I called them and waited 25 minutes on hold. In the end, the right one came three days later, on Tuesday, and now it works fine. Next time, I'm going to open the box before the rider leaves. It only takes a minute, and he can take a wrong item back at once. One thing is still open: they promised me a RM30 voucher, but it hasn't come yet. If it isn't here by Friday, I'll call them again.

P PAST · THE SCENE AND WHAT HAPPENED

P PRESENT · HOW IT ENDED, AND NOW

F FUTURE · NEXT TIME

! STILL OPEN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Kumar tells Ali about his car service. Scene and what happened → how it ended → next time → still open.

- [ ] Last Monday I took half a day off for my car service at 2 p.m. When I got to the workshop, my booking wasn't there.
- [ ] Next time, I'll call them the day before and check the booking.
- [ ] They made me wait an hour and a half. In the end, they did it at 3.30, and now the car is fine.
- [ ] One thing is still open: I still don't know what happened to my booking.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · the scene and what happened · **P** = Present · how it ended, and now · **F** = Future · next time · **!** = Still open

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SET THE SCENE

- [ ] Two weeks ago, I …
- [ ] I ordered / booked … for …
- [ ] It was supposed to …
- [ ] I was … when …

WHAT HAPPENED, IN ORDER

- [ ] First, …
- [ ] Then …
- [ ] After that, …
- [ ] After … minutes, …

HOW IT ENDED · NOW

- [ ] In the end, …
- [ ] It took … days.
- [ ] So now …

NEXT TIME · STILL OPEN

- [ ] Next time, I'm going to …
- [ ] One thing is still open: …
- [ ] I'm still waiting for …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. It was supposed to come on Saturday morning. [so / because / but] The rider only came at 4 p.m.

   _____

2. I was having a shower. [because / when / so] The rider came.

   _____

3. I opened the box. [because / For example, / First … then …] I called customer service.

   _____

4. I waited 25 minutes on hold. [In the end, / because / For example,] They said sorry and sent the right one.

   _____

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Two weeks ago, I _____ a microwave online. (A finished event, with a time)
   - ○ ordering
   - ○ was order
   - ○ ordered
2. I _____ at home all Saturday morning, but nobody came. (The background: what was going on)
   - ○ waiting
   - ○ was waiting
   - ○ was wait
3. The right microwave finally _____ on Tuesday. (A past verb that does not take -ed)
   - ○ comed
   - ○ came
   - ○ come
4. I _____ the box before the rider left. (Something you did not do)
   - ○ didn't checked
   - ○ didn't check
   - ○ not check

SLIDE 09 Background and event: was … -ing when …

For the background (what was going on), use was / were + -ing. For the short event in the middle of it, use the past: came, called, cancelled. It was supposed to … = the plan that did not happen.

I **was having** a shower **when** the rider **came**.

We **were waiting** for the food **when** the app **cancelled** the order.

It **was supposed to** come on Saturday morning. (the plan)

The rider **came** at 4 p.m. (what really happened → past)

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

PAST · SCENE AND WHAT HAPPENED

… ago, I ordered / booked … It was supposed to … I was … when …

P

PRESENT · HOW IT ENDED, NOW

Then … So I … In the end, … Now …

F

FUTURE · NEXT TIME

Next time, I'm going to …

!

STILL OPEN

One thing is still open: … (only if there is one)

SLIDE 11

Story Interview

The speaker tells a service story from a mixed-up card. The listener cannot see the card: they write the story in order, ask for what is missing and read it back.

1. Round 1 (3:00). Speaker: your card is mixed up. Tell it in order: scene → what happened → how it ended → next time.
2. Listener: no card. Write key words, number the events. Round 1: ask 'When was this?' 'What next?' Read it back.
3. Round 2 (2:00): listeners move one seat. Speaker: the whole story, shorter. Listener: write, then ask. Next column.
4. Round 3 (2:00), frames closed: speakers close the plan, keep only the card. New listener. Then swap: rounds 1–3.

Card 1 · Internet at the new condo

Card 2 · Lunch for a customer meeting

Card 3 · The birthday cake

Card 4 · The flight refund

Listener's note: key words and times

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Started with …			
When and where			
What happened: 1, 2, 3			
How it ended · next time			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mei Ling asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. **Why didn't you check the box before the rider left?**
2. **How long did you wait for the right one?**
3. **What will you do if the voucher doesn't come?**

Start with: **I was …, so I … · … days: it came on … · If it isn't here by …, I'll …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

At work: last Wednesday a courier left the office's 10 boxes of printing paper on the wrong floor. You looked for them for two days. On Friday you found them on the 3rd floor, and Ali helped you carry them up. Tell Mr. Tan what happened: scene → what happened, in order → how it ended → next time (your own idea). Or tell a real story from your own work.

Last Wednesday, a courier … · First we …, then … · In the end, … · Next time, I'm going to …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Sets the scene first: when, where and what it was about.
- [ ] Tells the events in an order the listener can write down.
- [ ] Says how it ended and one thing for next time.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Setting the scene	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Events in order	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
How it ended · next time	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Internet at the new condo

You are a colleague at lunch. Your colleague tells you a story: write it in order. Missing a part? Ask: When and where was this? What happened next? How did it end? What about next time?

Card 2 · Lunch for a customer meeting

You are Mr. Tan. You were out of the office that day. Write what happened, in order. Missing a part? Ask: When was it? What happened next? How did it end? What will we do next time?

Card 3 · The birthday cake

You are the bakery manager. You were not in the shop that day. Write what happened, in order, for your report. Missing a part? Ask: When? What next? How did it end? And next time?

Card 4 · The flight refund

You are a friend. Your friend tells you a story: write it in order. Missing a part? Ask: When was this? What happened next? How did it end? What will you do next time?

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · Internet at the new condo

In the end: technician came a week late · Took Monday off; waited from 9 a.m. · Last month: new condo in Skudai; internet booked for Monday 9 a.m. · 2 p.m.: I called. They said: 'Next Monday.' · Next time: get the date by SMS

Card 2 · Lunch for a customer meeting

12.45: the app cancelled the order · Next time: order the day before · Last Friday: office lunch for 12 on a food app, 12.30 (customer meeting) · 1.15: we all ate nasi lemak from downstairs · In the end: RM240 back, 3 days later

Card 3 · The birthday cake

Next time: keep the receipt · Saturday 1 p.m.: at the shop: no cake! · Last Wednesday: ordered a chocolate cake (RM120), son's party Saturday at 3 · Waited 40 minutes; they gave me a cheesecake · In the end: at the party by 2.30

Card 4 · The flight refund

7 weeks later: RM460 came back · A week before the trip: flight cancelled · Emailed 3 times: 'Please wait 14 days.' · In July: 2 tickets, JB → Penang, RM460 · Same day: asked for the money back · Next time: phone, don't email